RIIM — Relationship Identification Integrity Module

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Canonical Definition

Relationship Identification Integrity Module (RIIM) defines the structural conditions under which operational relationships between actors remain identifiable, distinguishable, traceable, reconstructable, and operationally valid throughout governance analysis.

RIIM governs relationship identification.

The module establishes the conditions required to determine who is connected to whom before authority, responsibility, control, oversight, evidence, accountability, and consequence can be evaluated.

Module Operational Role

RIIM serves as the identification layer of the Relationship Accountability Standard.

Its role is to establish visibility of relationships before governance analysis proceeds to subsequent accountability layers.

RIIM answers the first operational question:

Which actors are actually connected within the operational environment?

Module Operational Space

RIIM governs:

- relationship identification
- actor identification
- relationship visibility
- relationship discovery
- relationship reconstruction
- relationship traceability
- governance relationship mapping

The module applies wherever governance requires identification of participating actors and their relationships.

Module Function

The module ensures that governance can identify:

- direct relationships
- indirect relationships
- contractual relationships
- supervisory relationships
- delegated relationships
- organizational relationships
- Human-AI relationships
- AI-agent relationships
- multi-party relationships

before accountability analysis begins.

Its function is to prevent invisible actors from remaining hidden within governance structures.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define the Relationship Environment

Identify the operational environment being analyzed.

Examples:

- organizations
- contractor networks
- manufacturing chains
- supply chains
- AI systems
- multi-agent systems
- Human-AI environments
- robotics ecosystems

2. Identify Participating Actors

Identify all actors participating in the environment.

Examples:

- individuals
- organizations
- departments
- contractors
- subcontractors
- staffing agencies
- AI agents
- autonomous systems
- robots

3. Identify Existing Relationships

Determine which actors maintain operational relationships.

Examples:

- direct reporting relationships
- contractual relationships
- supervisory relationships
- delegated relationships
- collaborative relationships
- execution relationships

4. Validate Relationship Existence

Determine whether identified relationships actually exist
in operational reality.

Governance must distinguish:

- formal relationships
- operational relationships
- assumed relationships
- undocumented relationships

5. Preserve Relationship Traceability

Maintain sufficient evidence to reconstruct identified relationships
throughout governance analysis.

Use Case 1 — Multi-Layer Contractor Network

Scenario

A manufacturing company operates through multiple contractors and subcontractors.

Application

RIIM identifies every participating actor and maps operational relationships between organizations.

Result

Governance gains visibility into the complete relationship structure before responsibility and accountability analysis begins.

Use Case 2 — Orchestrated Agent Environment

Scenario

A Human-AI environment contains human supervisors, AI agents, orchestration systems, external tools, and robotic execution systems.

Application

RIIM identifies participating actors and maps operational relationships between all entities.

Result

Governance gains visibility into the complete operational relationship structure before authority and accountability analysis proceeds.

Canonical Closing Statement

Relationship Identification Integrity Module (RIIM) defines the structural conditions under which operational relationships between actors remain identifiable, distinguishable, traceable, reconstructable, and operationally valid throughout governance analysis.

Governance cannot analyze what it cannot see. Relationship identification therefore becomes the first operational step of accountability governance.

Related Documents

→ Relationship Accountability Standard - (RAS)

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